

Who counts as a teacher

Occupation of the longest job held last year, CPS ASEC — three Census classifications, 28 survey years

Surveys 1998-2002

teaching years 1997-2001

1990 Census classification

Surveys 2003-2019

teaching years 2002-2018

2002/2010 Census classification (SOC)

Surveys 2020-2025

teaching years 2019-2024

2018 Census classification (SOC 2018)

155	Prekindergarten & kindergarten	2300	Preschool & kindergarten	2300	Preschool & kindergarten
156	Elementary school†	2310	Elementary & middle school†	2310	Elementary & middle school†
157	Secondary school†	2320	Secondary school	2320	Secondary school
158	Special education	2330	Special education	2330	Special education
159	Teachers, n.e.c.	2340	Other teachers & instructors	2360	Other teachers & instructors

Are the codes traceable across census years?

- Yes

as a block: the K-12 teaching group maps one-to-one across the three classifications. Every figure uses the union of the codes, never a sub-code across regimes.
- †

sub-codes are not: middle-school teachers sit under elementary or secondary before 2003 and with elementary (2310) after; “other teachers” is renumbered 2340 → 2360 in 2020.
- Yes

within each survey: last year’s job (OCCUP) and the current job (PEIOOCC) share one classification, so no leaver/switch comparison straddles a code change (seam surveys: 2003 and 2020).
- Yes

for people, but only two years: the CPS links the same person across two consecutive March interviews (PERIDNUM); postsecondary instructors and teaching assistants are never included.